

AI FDE PROGRAM · ENGAGEMENT GUIDE

Top 10 Rules of Engagement

— For a demanding FDE program —

01		Nominated for a demanding program You are here because you were nominated for a demanding FDE program.
02		Treat it as build-first Treat the program as an intense, build-first learning journey.
03		Respect the 166-hour commitment Respect the full 166-hour commitment, including orientation, pre-day, and 25 teaching days.
04		Show up ready every day Be present, punctual, prepared, and active every day.
05		Take stand-ups & peer-pods seriously Participate seriously in daily stand-ups and peer-pod responsibilities.
06		Aim for FDE-Ready from day one Work toward the FDE-Ready graduation bar from day one.
07		Know the graduation bar Aim for FDE-Ready, understand what Conditional means, and avoid falling into Develop-First through passive participation or weak execution.
08		Expect continuous evaluation Remember that continuous evaluation will happen throughout the program.
09		Submit everything on time Submit all required artifacts, agreements, and deliverables on time.
10		Escalate early when blocked Ask for help early, use the defined escalation paths, and do not stay blocked.

FDE MINDSET GUIDE • PART 1

20 FDE Mindset Principles

Part 1 • Principles 1–10



FDE MINDSET GUIDE • PART 2

20 FDE Mindset Principles

— Part 2 • Principles 11–20 —

11	Systems thinking See the whole system: people, process, data, technology, and operations.	 →  →  →  → 
12	Product instinct Focus on users, friction, adoption, and feedback loops.	 →  →  →  → 
13	Engineering pragmatism Prefer the simplest deployable architecture.	 →  →  →  → 
14	Translation mindset Turn business pain into technical design and executive choices.	 →  →  →  → 
15	Trust-by-evidence mindset Back every claim with evidence, validation, and metrics.	 →  →  →  → 
16	Security-by-design mindset Build privacy, control, auditability, and compliance in from the start.	 →  →  →  → 
17	Fast feedback mindset Tighten the loop from user pain to prototype to deployment.	 →  →  →  → 
18	Cross-functional fluency Work effectively across business, engineering, data, security, and leadership.	 →  →  →  → 
19	Narrative discipline Explain what was found, what was built, why it matters, and what remains.	 →  →  →  → 
20	Founder-like accountability Take end-to-end ownership and stand by the outcome.	 →  →  →  → 

The Pedagogy

01		Cohort based
02		Design Thinking
03		Mind maps
04		Mental Models
05		Exploratory
06		Case studies
07		Labs
08		Quiz
09		Q&A
10		Elevator Pitch presentation by teams
11		Templates
12		Checklists

AI FDE Program Overview

Day-wise & hour-wise structure



166
hours



42
sessions



4 hrs/session
(teaching)



40 × 4-hr teaching sessions +
1-hr orientation + 5-hr pre-day = 166 hrs



42 total sessions across 5 weeks



Week 1

FDE identity from Day 1



Week 2

Azure-AI engineering



Week 3

Discovery &
semantic-layer decisions



Week 4

Spec-Driven
Development



Week 5

Capstone challenge
studios



Ambiguity-handling woven through every session